“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Ādi-līlā

Chapter 5

Determining the Truth of Śrī Nityānanda

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the Anubhāṣya, 2026)

1 I bow to the Lord Śrī Nityānanda, whose divine opulence is endless and wondrous. By His will even a fool can come to know and describe His true nature.[1]

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura!

3 In these six verses I have told of the glory of Kṛṣṇa Caitanya; in five verses I now tell the whole truth of Nityānanda.

4 Kṛṣṇa, the source of all avatāras, is Bhagavān Himself, and Śrī Balarāma is His second body.

5 The two are one in nature; only Their bodies differ. Balarāma is the first expansion of Kṛṣṇa’s body and His helper in His pastimes.

6 That Kṛṣṇa is Śrī Caitanyacandra in Navadvīpa, and that Balarāma is Śrī Nityānanda, who is with Him.

7 “Saṅkarṣaṇa, the Lord who lies in the Causal Ocean, the Lord who lies in the Garbha Ocean, the Lord who lies in the Ocean of Milk, and Śeṣa are

His portions and the parts of His portions: may that Rāma who is called Nityānanda be my refuge." (diary of Svarūpa Dāmodara)[2]

8 Śrī Balarāma Gosāñi is the original Saṅkarṣaṇa. Assuming five forms, He serves Kṛṣṇa.

9 He Himself assists Kṛṣṇa in His pastimes, and in four other bodies He carries out the work of creation.

10 His work of creation and the rest is service done at Kṛṣṇa's command; and as Śeṣa He serves Kṛṣṇa in many ways.

11 In all these forms He tastes the bliss of serving Kṛṣṇa. And that same Balarāma is Nityānanda, the companion of Gaura.

12 I shall explain the meaning of the seventh verse in four verses, so that all may know the truth of Nityānanda.[3]

13 "I take refuge in Śrī Nityānanda Rāma, whose form called Saṅkarṣaṇa shines amid the fourfold expansion (catur-vyūha) in the all-pervading world of Vaikuṇṭha, full of every opulence and beyond māyā." (diary of Svarūpa Dāmodara)[4]

14 Beyond material nature lies the abode called Paravyoma. Like Kṛṣṇa's own form, it is endowed with every opulence and every divine quality.

15 There lie endless, all-pervading abodes — Brahman, Vaikuṇṭha and others — and in them Kṛṣṇa and His avatāras dwell.[5]

16 In its highest region is the realm known as Kṛṣṇaloka, which abides in three divisions — Dvārakā, Mathurā and Gokula.

17 Above all is Śrī Gokula, the abode of Vraja, which is also called Śrī Goloka, Śvetadvīpa and Vṛndāvana.

18 Like Kṛṣṇa's body, it is all-pervading, endless and vast; it extends above and below without any bound.[6]

19 By Kṛṣṇa's will it is manifest within the universe, yet it remains one and the same: it does not have two bodies.

20 Its land is cintāmaṇi, its forests are full of wish-fulfilling trees; yet eyes of flesh see it as no different from the material world.[7]

21 With eyes of love one sees it as it truly is — the place where Kṛṣṇa sports with the cowherd boys and girls.

22 "I worship Govinda, the original Person, who tends the surabhi cows in abodes built of cintāmaṇi gems and surrounded by millions of wish-fulfilling trees, and who is served with reverence by hundreds of thousands of Lakṣmīs." (Brahma-saṁhitā, 5.29)[8]

23 In Mathurā and Dvārakā He manifests His own form and, becoming the fourfold expansion (catur-vyūha), sports in many forms.

24 Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha are the source of every catur-vyūha; They are transcendent (*turīya*) and pure.

25 In these three abodes Kṛṣṇa is wholly given to His pastimes; there He plays with His own associates without end.

26 In the midst of Paravyoma He manifests His own form and, as Nārāyaṇa, enjoys pastimes of many kinds.

27 Kṛṣṇa's own form has only two arms; in the form of Nārāyaṇa that same body has four.

28 He holds the conch, disc, club and lotus and is full of supreme majesty; His feet are served by His potencies Śrī, Bhū and Nīlā.[9]

29 Though His nature is simply to play, out of mercy to the jīvas He does one work:

30 Granting the four kinds of liberation — sālokya, sāmīpya, sārṣṭi and sārūpya — He delivers the jīvas.

31 Those liberated by merging into Brahman have no access there; they all remain outside it.

32 Outside Vaikuṇṭha lies a sphere of light — the radiance of Kṛṣṇa's body, supremely bright.

33 It is called Siddhaloka and lies beyond material nature. It is spiritual, yet the spiritual potency displays no variety there.

34 It is like the disc of the sun: from outside it is a featureless glow, but within are the sun's chariot and all its variety.

35 "Many have fixed their minds on the Lord — some by devotion, others by loving desire (*kāma*), enmity, fear or affection — and, casting off the sin in those feelings, have attained Him." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 7.1.29)[10]

36 "The goal of the Lord's enemies and that of His beloved ones are sometimes spoken of as one, because Brahman and Kṛṣṇa are one, as the rays are one with the sun." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.2.278)[11]

37 So in Paravyoma there are manifold pastimes of the spiritual potency, while outside it a featureless sphere of light is manifest.

38 That featureless Brahman is light alone, and those who are fit for *sāyujya* are absorbed in it.

39 “Beyond darkness lies Siddhaloka, where dwell the siddhas, immersed in the bliss of Brahman, and the demons slain by Hari.” (Brahmāṇḍa-purāṇa; Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.2.280)[12]

40 In that Paravyoma, on the four sides of Nārāyaṇa, the catur-vyūha of Dvārakā is present in a second manifestation.

41 Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha — this is the second catur-vyūha, transcendent and pure.

42 There the form of Rāma is Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa. He is the shelter of the spiritual potency, the cause of all causes.

43 One manifestation of the spiritual potency is called *śuddha-sattva*, pure spiritual existence, and of it all the abodes of Vaikuṇṭha are made.

44 The six kinds of opulence there are all spiritual; know for certain that all of them are the splendour of Saṅkarṣaṇa.

45 There is a potency called *jīva*, known as the marginal (*taṭasthā*) potency; and Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa is the shelter of all jīvas.

46 Saṅkarṣaṇa is the shelter of the Puruṣa from whom the universe arises and into whom it dissolves.

47 He is the shelter of all, wondrous in every way, His opulence boundless; even Ananta cannot describe His glory.

48 The transcendent Saṅkarṣaṇa, pure spiritual existence (*viśuddha-sattva*), is a part of Nityānanda-Rāma.[13]

49 Thus I have briefly explained the eighth verse. Now hear attentively the meaning of the ninth.

50 “I take refuge in Śrī Nityānanda Rāma. A part of Him is the original Lord, the Puruṣa, the master of māyā, who lies in person in the midst of the Causal Ocean, His body the shelter of countless universes.” (diary of Svarūpa Dāmodara)[14]

51 Outside Vaikuṇṭha is the luminous abode, and beyond it lies what is called the Kāraṇārṇava, the Causal Ocean.

52 Encircling Vaikuṇṭha is an ocean, endless and shoreless; it has no bound.

53 In Vaikuṇṭha earth and all the elements are spiritual; material elements never arise there.

54 That spiritual water is the supreme cause; a single drop of it is the Gaṅgā, purifier of the fallen.

55 In that Causal Ocean the same Saṅkarṣaṇa lies in the form of one of His parts.

56 He is the Puruṣa, creator of the *mahat-tattva*, the cause of the world. This first avatāra casts His glance upon māyā.

57 The potency māyā stays outside the Causal Ocean; māyā cannot touch its waters.

58 That māyā exists in two ways; as the material cause of the world it is called *pradhāna* or *prakṛti*.[15]

59 Inert prakṛti is not the cause of the world; Kṛṣṇa shows her mercy by infusing her with His potency.

60 By Kṛṣṇa's potency prakṛti becomes a secondary cause, just as iron burns by the power of fire.

61 Therefore Kṛṣṇa is the original cause of the world. To call prakṛti the cause is like taking the teats on a goat's neck for an udder.

62 In her aspect as māyā I call her the efficient cause of the world; but even that is not so, for the true maker and cause is Nārāyaṇa.[16]

63 As the potter is the efficient cause of the pot, so the Puruṣa-avatāra is the maker of the world.

64 Kṛṣṇa is the maker, and māyā only helps Him, as the wheel, the stick and other tools are causes of the pot.

65 From afar the Puruṣa glances upon māyā and places in her the seed — the jīvas.

66 By a mere semblance of His body He unites with māyā, and from māyā the hosts of universes are then born.[17]

67 Into all those countless, endless universes the Puruṣa enters, taking as many forms.

68 When the breath goes out of the Puruṣa's nostrils, the universes become manifest with His exhalation.

69 And when the breath enters again, the universes enter the Puruṣa's body with it.

70 As specks of dust move through the holes of a lattice window, so hosts of universes move through the pores of the Puruṣa's skin.

71 "The lords of the universes, born from His pores, abide for the span of one of His breaths. That Mahā-Viṣṇu is a particular kalā of Govinda, the original Person, whom I worship." (Brahma-saṁhitā, 5.48)[18]

72 "Where am I, a creature with a body seven spans tall, enclosed in the pot of a universe wrapped in prakṛti, the mahat, false ego, ether, air, fire, water and earth? And where is Your greatness, when countless such universes drift like atoms through the pores of Your skin, as through the openings of a lattice?" (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.14.11)[19]

73 A part of a part is called a *kalā*. Śrī Balarāma is Govinda's second body.[20]

74 One of His forms is Śrī Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa, and Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa's part, the Puruṣa, is counted as a *kalā*.

75 He whom I call a kalā is Mahā-Viṣṇu. He is the source of the Puruṣa-avatāras, ever victorious.

76 The Lords who lie in the Garbha and Kṣīra oceans are both called Puruṣas, and He whose parts They are is Viṣṇu, the abode of all the universes.

77 "Viṣṇu has three forms called Puruṣas: the first creates the mahat, the second abides within the universe, and the third dwells in all beings. Knowing Them, one is set free." (Sātvata-tantra; Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta, Pūrva-khaṇḍa, 2.9)

78 Though I call Him a kalā of Kṛṣṇa, He is the source of Matsya, Kūrma and the other avatāras.

79 “All these (avatāras) are portions (*aṁśa*) and parts of portions (*kalā*) of the Puruṣa, but Kṛṣṇa is Bhagavān Himself. Age after age They bring happiness to the world when it is troubled by the enemies of Indra.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.3.28)[2122]

80 That Puruṣa creates, maintains and dissolves the world; He sends forth many avatāras and sustains the world.

81 The part that descends for creation and the rest I call by the name *avatāra*.

82 He is the first avatāra, the Mahā-Puruṣa, Bhagavān — the seed of all avatāras, the abode and shelter of all.

83 “The Puruṣa is the first avatāra of the Supreme. Time, nature, prakṛti as cause and effect, the mind, the elements, false ego, the guṇas, the senses, the universal body (*virāṭ*) and the Vairāja (*svarāṭ*), and all beings, moving and unmoving — all these are the splendour of the Great One.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 2.6.42)[23]

84 “In the beginning, desiring to create the worlds, Bhagavān accepted the form of the Puruṣa, joined with the mahat and the other principles and possessed of sixteen potencies (*kalā*).” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.3.1)[24]

85 He is the shelter of all, and the world rests in Him; as the Supersoul He is the support of the world.

86 He has a twofold relation with prakṛti, and yet there is not even a trace of contact between Him and prakṛti.

87 “This is the lordship of the Lord: though He abides within material nature, He is never affected by its qualities — just as the intelligence of those who have taken shelter of Him is not affected.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.11.38)[25]

88 So the Gītā too declares again and again that the truth of the Lord is always endowed with inconceivable potency:

89 “I abide in the world, and the world is in Me; and yet I do not abide in the world, nor is the world in Me.

90 Know this to be My inconceivable power.” Such is the meaning the Gītā proclaims.

91 He of whom that Puruṣa is called a part is Nityānanda-Rāma, the companion of Caitanya.

92 Such is the explanation of the ninth verse. Now hear attentively the meaning of the tenth.

93 “I take refuge in Śrī Nityānanda Rāma. A part of His part is the blessed Garbhodakaśāyī, whose navel-lotus, with all the worlds as its stem, is the birthplace of Brahmā, the creator of the worlds.” (diary of Svarūpa Dāmodara)[26]

94 Having created endless universes, that Puruṣa entered them all, becoming many forms.

95 Entering, He saw only darkness everywhere, and finding no place to stay, He reflected.

96 From the perspiration of His own body He created water and with it filled half the universe.

97 The universe measures fifty crores of yojanas, equal in length and breadth.

98 Filling half with water, He made His dwelling there; in the other half He manifested the fourteen worlds.

99 There He manifested Vaikuṇṭha, His own abode, and rested on the water with Śeṣa as His bed.

100–101 There He lay on Ananta as His bed. He has a thousand heads and a thousand faces, a thousand hands and feet and a thousand eyes. He is the seed of all avatāras and the cause of the world.[27]

102 From His navel-lotus a lotus arose, and that lotus became the birthplace of Brahmā.

103 In the stem of that lotus the fourteen worlds came to be, and He, becoming Brahmā, brought forth the creation.

104 Taking the form of Viṣṇu, He maintains the world. Viṣṇu is beyond the guṇas; the guṇas of māyā never touch Him.

105 Assuming the form of Rudra, He destroys the world. Creation, maintenance and dissolution all take place by His will.

106 He is Hiraṇyagarbha, the Indweller, the cause of the world; and it is a part of Him that is conceived as the universal form (*virāṭ*).

107 Great as Nārāyaṇa is, He is only a part of a part of Lord Nityānanda, the crown of all avatāras.

108 I have explained the meaning of the tenth verse; now hear attentively the meaning of the eleventh.

109 “I take refuge in Śrī Nityānanda Rāma. A part of a part of His part is Viṣṇu who lies on the Ocean of Milk, the Supersoul and maintainer of all beings; and Ananta, who upholds the earth, is a portion of that Viṣṇu.” (diary of Svarūpa Dāmodara)[28]

110 Within the stem of Nārāyaṇa’s navel-lotus is the earth, and within the earth are counted seven oceans.[29]

111 There, in the midst of the Ocean of Milk, is the island called Śvetadvīpa, the abode of Viṣṇu the maintainer.

112 He is the Indweller of all beings, the maintainer of the world and its master.

113 In each yuga and manvantara He takes many avatāras, establishing dharma and destroying adharma.

114 Even the gods cannot see Him; they go to the shore of the Ocean of Milk and offer Him prayers.

115 Then He descends and protects the world. His splendour is endless, beyond all counting.

116 And that Viṣṇu is a part of a part of a part of Lord Nityānanda, the crown of all avatāras.

117 That Viṣṇu, in the form of Śeṣa, holds the earth, and does not even know where on His heads it lies.

118 On the circle of His thousand broad hoods hosts of gems glitter, outshining the sun.

119 The earth, fifty crores of yojanas wide, rests on one of His hoods like a mustard seed.

120 That Ananta Śeṣa is an avatāra in the form of a devotee; He knows nothing but service to the Lord.

121 With His thousand mouths He sings of Kṛṣṇa's qualities; He sings without cease and never reaches their end.

122 From His mouth Sanaka and the other Kumāras hear the *Bhāgavatam*, while He, awash in the joy of love, tells of the qualities of Bhagavān.

123 He becomes umbrella, sandals, bed, pillow, garments, resting place, dwelling, sacred thread and throne.

124 Assuming all these different forms He serves Kṛṣṇa; and because He has reached the utmost limit of service to Kṛṣṇa, He bears the name Śeṣa.[30]

125 That Ananta I call but one kalā of Him. Such is Lord Nityānanda — who can know His play?

126 By all these proofs I know the full truth of Nityānanda. If I call Him Ananta, what glory is that to Him?

127 Or else, accepting the words of the devotees as true, I say: everything is possible in Him, for He is the source of the avatāras.

128 One who knows that the avatāras and their source are non-different speaks in this way — just as in the past people saw in Kṛṣṇa this or that avatāra:[31]

129 some said that Kṛṣṇa was Nara-Nārāyaṇa Himself, others that He was Vāmana Himself,

130 and still others that He was an avatāra of Kṣīrodaśāyī. None of this is impossible: the words of all are true.

131 When Kṛṣṇa, the shelter of all portions, descends, all His portions come and unite in Him.

132 So each speaks of Him in the form in which he knows Him. Everything is possible in Kṛṣṇa; none of it is false.

133 Therefore Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Gosāñi performed the pastimes of all the avatāras and showed them to everyone.

134 In this way Nityānanda is manifest as Ananta, and in that same mood He says, “I am Caitanya’s servant.”

135 Sometimes He plays the guru, sometimes the friend, sometimes the servant — just as He once played in Vraja in these three moods.

136 Becoming a bull, He would fight with Kṛṣṇa head to head; and sometimes Kṛṣṇa would massage His feet.

137 He thinks of Himself as a servant and knows Kṛṣṇa as His Master; He considers Himself but a kalā of Kṛṣṇa’s kalā.

138 “Pretending to be bulls, the two would bellow and fight with each other; imitating the cries of animals, They roamed about like ordinary children.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.11.40)

139 “Sometimes, when His elder brother lay tired from play with His head on a cowherd boy’s lap, Kṛṣṇa Himself would give Him rest by massaging

His feet and serving Him in other ways." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.15.14)

140 (Baladeva said in wonder:) "Who is she, and where has she come from? Is she divine, human or demonic? Most likely she is the māyā of My Master, for no other can bewilder even Me." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.13.37)[32]

141 (Baladeva said:) "The guardians of all the worlds bear on their crowned heads the dust of His lotus feet, the holiest of holy places; and Brahmā, Śiva, Lakṣmī and I Myself, mere parts of His part, carry it on our heads forever. What then is a king's throne to Him?" (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.68.37)[33]

142 Kṛṣṇa alone is the Lord; all others are His servants. As He makes each one dance, so each one dances.

143 In the same way Caitanya Gosāñi alone is the Lord; all the rest are His associates or His servants.

144–145 Nityānanda, Advaita Ācārya, Śrīvāsa and others play the part of His elders and gurus, and all the rest are His juniors, equals and seniors. All are His associates and helpers in His pastimes, and with them all Gaura-rāya accomplishes His purpose.

146 Advaita Ācārya and Nityānanda are His two limbs (*aṅga*); with these two the Lord performs all His pastimes.[34]

147 Advaita Ācārya Gosāñi is the Lord Himself. The Lord honours Him as a guru, yet He is His servant.[35]

148 The truth of Ācārya Gosāñi cannot be told: it was He who brought Kṛṣṇa down and delivered the world.

149 Nityānanda Svarūpa, appearing before as Lakṣmaṇa, served Rāma as His younger brother.[36]

150 Everything Rāma did brought Him suffering, and Lakṣmaṇa, of His own free will, bore that suffering with Him.

151 Being the younger brother, He could not object; so Lakṣmaṇa kept silent and grieved within.

152 In Kṛṣṇa's descent He became the elder brother for the sake of service, and He gave Kṛṣṇa many joys to taste.

153 Rāma and Lakṣmaṇa are particular portions of Kṛṣṇa and Balarāma, and when Kṛṣṇa and Balarāma descend, Rāma and Lakṣmaṇa enter into Them.[37]

154 Together with those portions They take the roles of elder and younger brother, and the scriptures describe Them as the whole and His portion.

155 "I worship Govinda, the original Person, who, abiding through His kalās in Rāma and other forms, manifested many avatāras in the worlds, but who Himself, the Supreme Person, appeared as Kṛṣṇa." (Brahma-saṁhitā, 5.39)[38]

156 Śrī Caitanya is that Kṛṣṇa, and Nityānanda is Rāma. Nityānanda fulfils all of Caitanya's desires.

157 The ocean of Nityānanda's glory is endless and shoreless. I touch but a single drop of it — and that only by His mercy.

158 Hear one more glory of His mercy: He raised a fallen soul to the very highest.[39]

159 This story is as secret as the Vedas and not fit to be told; still I tell it to reveal His mercy.

160 In overflowing joy I write of Your grace. O Nityānanda Prabhu, forgive my offence!

161 Avadhūta Gosāñi had a servant who was an abode of love; his name was Mīnaketana Rāmadāsa.[40]

162 In my house there was saṅkīrtana day and night, and he came there by invitation.

163 Full of great love, he sat down in the courtyard, and all the Vaiṣṇavas bowed at his feet.

164 As they bowed, he would climb on the back of one, and in his love strike another with his flute or slap yet another.

165 From those eyes, the very sight of which brings tears to one's heart, flowed an unbroken stream of tears.

166 At times I saw the hair on some limb stand on end like kadamba blossoms; one limb would stiffen while another trembled.

167 When he roared out "Nityānanda!", all who saw it were filled with wonder.

168 A respectable brāhmaṇa named Guṇārṇava Miśra was serving the Deity there.

169 Rāmadāsa sat in the courtyard, but the brāhmaṇa did not greet him; seeing this, Mīnaketana said angrily:[41]

170 “Here is a second Romaharṣaṇa Sūta, who did not rise to greet Baladeva when he saw Him!”[42]

171 Having said this, he danced and sang and rejoiced; but the brāhmaṇa went on with his service to Kṛṣṇa and showed no anger.

172 At the end of the festival he was leaving, having given his blessings, when a dispute arose between him and my brother.

173 My brother had firm faith in Caitanya Prabhu, but towards Nityānanda only a semblance of faith.

174 Knowing this, Rāmadāsa was grieved at heart, and so I rebuked my brother:

175 “The two brothers are one body, equally manifest. If you do not accept Nityānanda, you will be utterly ruined.

176 You have faith in one but show the other no respect: your standard is the logic of half a hen.

177 If you accept neither, you are an atheist; and to accept one and not the other is hypocrisy.”[43]

178 In anger Rāmadāsa broke his flute and went away, and at that very moment my brother was ruined.

179 Thus I have told of the power of His servant. Now I tell of something more — the nature of His mercy.

180 Because I had rebuked my brother — and He counted this as a virtue — that night the Lord appeared to me.

181 In a village called Jhāmaṭapura, near Naihāṭi, Nityānanda-Rāma appeared to me in a dream.[44]

182 I fell flat like a rod at His feet, and the Lord placed His lotus foot upon my head.

183 Again and again He said to me, “Rise, rise!” I rose, and seeing His form I was struck with wonder.

184 His huge body had a glossy dark lustre. He was as beautiful as Kandarpa, the god of love, in person, and had the bearing of a great champion wrestler.

185 His hands and feet were finely shaped, His eyes like lotuses; He wore silk on His head and silk as His garment.

186 Golden earrings hung in His ears, golden armlets and bracelets adorned His arms; ankle-bells rang on His feet, and a garland of flowers lay on His neck.

187 His body was anointed with sandal and graced with a lovely tilaka; His slow, intoxicated gait surpassed that of a maddened elephant.

188 His bright face outshone millions of moons; as He chewed betel, His teeth looked like pomegranate seeds.[45]

189 Intoxicated with love, His body swayed to right and left, and in a deep voice He called, “Kṛṣṇa! Kṛṣṇa!”

190 With a red staff in His hand He swayed like a maddened lion, and bees hovered all around His feet.

191 I saw His associates, all dressed as cowherds, all calling “Kṛṣṇa! Kṛṣṇa!” in loving rapture.

192 Some played horns and flutes, some danced and sang; one servant offered betel, another waved a cāmara.

193 I beheld the splendour of Nityānanda Svarūpa — what form, what qualities, what pastimes, all beyond this world!

194 Overwhelmed with bliss, I knew nothing at all. Then, smiling, the Lord spoke to me:

195 “O Kṛṣṇadāsa, Kṛṣṇadāsa, do not be afraid! Go to Vṛndāvana: there everything can be attained.”

196 Saying this, He touched me with His hand and sent me forth; and the Lord disappeared with His associates.[46]

197 I fell senseless to the ground; my dream broke, and I saw that morning had come.

198 I reflected on what I had seen and heard: the Lord had ordered me to go to Vṛndāvana.

199 At that very moment I set out, and by the Lord’s mercy I reached Vṛndāvana in happiness.

200 Glory, glory to Nityānanda, to Nityānanda-Rāma, by whose mercy I attained the abode of Vṛndāvana!

201 Glory, glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Him who is full of mercy, through whom I attained the shelter of Rūpa and Sanātana!

202 Through Him I attained the great soul Raghunātha; through Him I attained the shelter of Śrī Svarūpa.

203 By Sanātana's mercy I came to know the conclusions of bhakti; by Śrī Rūpa's mercy I came near to bhakti-rasa.[47]

204 Glory, glory to the lotus feet of Nityānanda, through which I attained Śrī Rādhā-Govinda!

205 I am more sinful than Jagāi and Mādhāi, lower than a worm in excrement.

206 Whoever hears my name loses his piety; whoever utters my name commits sin.

207 Who in all the world but Nityānanda alone would show mercy to one as despicable as I?

208 Intoxicated with love, Nityānanda is the avatāra of mercy; He makes no distinction between the high and the low.

209 He delivers whoever falls before Him; and so He delivered even a sinner like me.

210 He brought me, the most sinful, to Śrī Vṛndāvana, and to one as low as I He gave the feet of Śrī Rūpa.

211 The sight of Śrī Madana-Gopāla and Śrī Govinda — all this is not fit to be told.

212 Śrī Madana-Gopāla is the lord of Vṛndāvana, the enjoyer of the rāsa dance, the son of the king of Vraja Himself.

213 With Śrī Rādhā and Lalitā He dances the rāsa, appearing in a form that enchants even Cupid.

214 "Among them appeared Śauri (Kṛṣṇa), His lotus face smiling, wearing yellow garments and a garland — the very enchanter of Cupid." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.32.2)

215 By His own sweetness He draws the minds of all, and on either side Rādhā and Lalitā serve Him.

216 Nityānanda's mercy showed Him to me and gave me Śrī Rādhā and Madanamohana as my Lady and Lord.

217 To me, so lowly, He gave the sight of Śrī Govinda. It is not a thing to be told; it is beyond all telling.

218–219 In Vṛndāvana, at Yogapīṭha, in a grove of wish-fulfilling trees, there is a pavilion of jewels, and there on a jewelled throne sits Śrī Govinda, the son of the king of Vraja. Revealing His sweetness, He enchants the whole world.

220 On His left is Śrī Rādhikā with Her friends, and with them the Lord delights in the rāsa and so many other pastimes.

221 In his own world Brahmā, who sits on the lotus, meditates on Him and worships Him with the eighteen-syllable mantra.[48]

222 All the fourteen worlds meditate on Him, and in Vaikuṇṭha and the other abodes they sing of His pastimes and qualities.

223 His sweetness attracts even Lakṣmī. Rūpa Gosāñi has described that form:

224 “O friend, if you still care for the company of your relatives, do not look at that form of Hari called Govinda, standing here by Keśī-tīrtha: He smiles, His body bends in three places, His wide glance falls sidelong, His lips, tender as new shoots, rest upon the flute, and a peacock feather makes Him radiant.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.2.239)[49]

225 He is the son of the king of Vraja Himself — of this there is no doubt. The fool who thinks of Him as a mere image[50]

226 has no deliverance for that offence; he falls into a terrible hell. What more can I say?

227 Through Him I attained such a Lord as Govinda — who can describe the mercy of His feet?

228 All the circles of Vaiṣṇavas who dwell in Vṛndāvana are devoted to the name of Kṛṣṇa and are supremely auspicious.

229 Nityānanda and Śrī Caitanya are the treasure of their lives; they know nothing but devotion to Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa.

230 The dust of those Vaiṣṇavas’ feet and the shelter of their shade — this the mercy of Lord Nityānanda gave to me, the lowly one.

231 “There everything can be attained” — these words of the Lord are the sūtra, and this is my explanation of it.[51]

232 All this I attained when I came to Vṛndāvana, and all of it I attained by the mercy of this Lord.

233 Shamelessly I write my own story: Nityānanda’s qualities have made me mad and make me write.

234 The glory of Nityānanda Prabhu's qualities is boundless: even Śeṣa with His thousand mouths cannot reach its end.

235 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. *Anubhāṣya*: *ajñena* — "by one who does not know the scriptures", that is, by the author himself; *nirūpyate* — "is described": by Nityānanda's mercy even such a person can describe the truth about Him. ↩
2. *Anubhāṣya*: Saṅkarṣaṇa is Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa of the spiritual sky (Paravyoma); Kāraṇodakaśāyī is the original Puruṣa-avatāra; Garbhodakaśāyī is the second Puruṣa, Hiraṇyagarbha, the Viṣṇu of the whole universe (*samaṣṭi*); Kṣīrodakaśāyī is the third Puruṣa, the Viṣṇu of each being (*vyaṣṭi*); Śeṣa is Ananta. The edition ascribes the verse to the diary of Svarūpa Dāmodara. The same verse as Ādi 1.7. ↩
3. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: what is said in the seventh verse is explained in the eighth, ninth, tenth and eleventh verses of the invocation (Ādi 1.8–1.11), which the author now quotes and expounds (5.13, 5.50, 5.93, 5.109). ↩
4. The same verse as Ādi 1.8. ↩
5. The edition's heading: "Brahman and the worlds above it, the abodes of Kṛṣṇa and His avatāras." *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: in that realm are the all-pervading, endless abode of Brahman and the abodes of Vaikuṇṭha; in all of them dwell Kṛṣṇa Himself and all His avatāras. ↩
6. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «নাহিক নিয়ম» (another reading: «নাহি তাঁর সীমা»). ↩
7. The edition's heading: "To the eye of enjoyment it looks like the material world, but to the eye of devotion it is the spiritual land of cintāmaṇi, the field of Kṛṣṇa's pastimes." *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: even in the Vraja manifest on earth the land is cintāmaṇi and the forests are of wish-fulfilling trees. ↩
8. *Anubhāṣya*: the Lakṣmīs here are the gopīs, the beloved cowherd maidens of Vraja (*lakṣmyaḥ gopa-rāmāḥ*); *abhipālayantam* — "tending them in every way, as befits a cowherd". ↩
9. *Anubhāṣya*: in some Bengali manuscripts "Līlā-śakti" is read in place of "Nīlā"; these three potencies dwell in Vaikuṇṭha beside Nārāyaṇa. ↩

10. *Anubhāṣya*: this is Nārada's answer to Yudhiṣṭhira's question how Śiśupāla, who hated Kṛṣṇa, attained *sāyujya*: by *kāma* — the gopīs; by enmity — Dantavakra and Śiśupāla; by fear — Kaṁsa; by affection — the Pāṇḍavas. *Tad agham* is the sin born of desire and the other feelings; *tad-gatim* — the various kinds of liberation. The gopīs' *kāma* Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī calls prema: "The pure love of the gopīs came to be called *kāma*" (*Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu*). ↩
11. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: where the scriptures say that the Lord's enemies and His beloved ones attain the same, they speak only of the oneness of Brahman, which is like the rays, and Kṛṣṇa, who is like the sun. In truth His beloved ones attain the variety of Vaikuṇṭha, and His enemies Siddhaloka, where there are no pastimes. ↩
12. *Anubhāṣya*: *tamasaḥ pāre* — beyond the three guṇas; the siddhas are those perfected in the knowledge of featureless Brahman and in *kaivalya-yoga*. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: there dwell the Māyāvādīs, immersed in the bliss of Brahman, and asuras such as Kaṁsa, slain by the Lord; the yogīs of Patañjali's school who attain *kaivalya* also reach that world. ↩
13. *Anubhāṣya*: the text reads *aṁśa* ("part"), the *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya* *aṅga*; both readings mean the same. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa is spiritual *viśuddha-sattva*; He is the *aṅga*, that is, the *prakāśa*, of Nityānanda-Rāma. ↩
14. The same verse as Ādi 1.9. ↩
15. *Anubhāṣya* and *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the external potency has two parts. The efficient cause (*nimitta*), the guṇas, is called māyā; the material cause (*upādāna*) is *pradhāna*, which is also called *prakṛti* (the first is spoken of in 5.62). ↩
16. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Nārāyaṇa is the principal efficient cause of the world, as the potter is of the pot; māyā is a secondary cause, like the potter's wheel and stick (5.63–5.64). ↩
17. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *aṅgābhāsa* is only a semblance of bodily contact, not a real union with māyā. ↩
18. *Anubhāṣya*: the lords of the universes are the *samaṣṭi*-Viṣṇus and others; *jīvanti* — "they are manifest, they abide". ↩
19. *Anubhāṣya*: this is one of the prayers Brahmā offered to Kṛṣṇa after stealing the calves and cowherd boys, to atone for his offence; *tamaḥ* is unmanifest prakṛti. ↩
20. *Anubhāṣya*: *pratimūrti* — "second body" (see 5.4–5.5). ↩

21. *Anubhāṣya*: *ete* — “the avatāras named before”; *aṁśāḥ* — portions of the Puruṣa-avatāra, *kalāḥ* — portions of portions; *mṛḍayanti*, “make happy”, refers to these avatāras. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: “Rāma, Nṛsiṁha and others are portions or parts of the Puruṣa; They protect the world oppressed by demons.” ↩
22. The same verse as Ādi 2.67. ↩
23. *Anubhāṣya*: Brahmā is telling Nārada of the splendour of Kāraṇārṇavaśāyī: *kāla* — that which sets the guṇas in motion; *svabhāva* — their transformation; *sad-asat* — prakṛti as cause and effect; *manaḥ* — the mahat-tattva; *dravya* — the subtle and gross elements; *vikāra* — false ego; *virāṭ* — the collective body of the universe; *svarāṭ* — the Vairāja; *sthāsnu*, *cariṣṇu* — unmoving and moving bodies; all this is His splendour (*vibhūti*). ↩
24. *Anubhāṣya*: Bhagavān here is Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa; “the mahat and the rest” are the mahat, false ego, the five great elements, the eleven senses and the five *tanmātras*; the sixteen *kalās* are the fullness of power for creation — in the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, Śrī, Bhū, Kīrti, Ilā, Līlā, Kānti, Vidyā and nine potencies headed by Vimalā. ↩
25. The same verse as Ādi 2.55. ↩
26. The same verse as Ādi 1.10. *Anubhāṣya*: Garbhodakaśāyī is the second Puruṣa; the stem of the lotus is the support of the fourteen worlds; the lotus is the birthplace of Brahmā. ↩
27. *Anubhāṣya* cites the *Bhāgavatam* (1.3.4) and the Puruṣa-sūkta (“The Puruṣa has a thousand heads, a thousand eyes, a thousand feet”): the thousand-headed one is Garbhodakaśāyī Himself, not Ananta on whom He lies. The edition’s heading to 5.101: “He who is praised in the Puruṣa-sūkta of the Ṛg-veda.” ↩
28. The same verse as Ādi 1.11. *Anubhāṣya*: Ananta, the upholder of the earth, is a *kalā* of Kṣīrodakaśāyī, a part of His part. ↩
29. *Anubhāṣya* (after the *Siddhānta-śiromaṇi*): the seven oceans are of salt water, milk, curd, ghee, sugar-cane juice, wine and fresh water; south of the salt ocean is the Ocean of Milk, where Vāsudeva dwells. ↩
30. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *śeṣatā* — “the last, utmost limit of service”. *Anubhāṣya* cites the *Bhāgavatam* (10.2.8): “My abode called Śeṣa.” ↩
31. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: as Kṛṣṇa was once equated with Vāmana and others, so those who make no distinction call Nityānanda “Ananta”; since devotees have said so, it is not false: in the highest truth everything is possible. ↩

32. The edition's heading: "Baladeva's wonder at the sight of Kṛṣṇa's yogamāyā." *Anubhāṣya*: when Brahmā had stolen the calves and the cowherd boys, Kṛṣṇa Himself became them and went on with His pastimes; one day Baladeva, seeing the unusual love of the cows, understood this and was amazed. ↩
33. *Anubhāṣya*: the Kauravas spoke insultingly of Kṛṣṇa and tried to win Baladeva to their side; angered, Baladeva answered them with these words. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: "Brahmā, Śiva, I, Baladeva, and Lakṣmī — some of us are His parts, some parts of His parts." ↩
34. *Anubhāṣya*: see Ādi 3.71 (Nityānanda and Advaita are the two *aṅgas* of Śrī Caitanya). ↩
35. *Anubhāṣya*: Mahāprabhu honoured Advaita Ācārya as one of His elders, but Advaita regarded Himself as Śrī Caitanya's servant. He was a contemporary and friend of Mahāprabhu's father; Śrī Īśvara Purī and Śrī Advaita were both disciples of Śrī Mādhavendra Purī, and since Mahāprabhu accepted Īśvara Purī as His initiating guru, Advaita was a godbrother of His guru and worthy of respect. ↩
36. *Anubhāṣya*: among the *daṇḍī* sannyāsīs of the ten orders (*daśanāmī*), a brahmacārī receives one of four names — *svarūpa*, *ānanda*, *prakāśa* or *caitanya*. During His pilgrimage Nityānanda Prabhu stayed with a sannyāsī whose title was *tīrtha* or *āśrama*, and so His brahmacārī name was "Nityānanda-svarūpa". ↩
37. *Anubhāṣya* (after the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*): Rāma, Lakṣmaṇa, Bharata and Śatrughna are avatāras of Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha; the *Padma-purāṇa* calls Rāma Nārāyaṇa, and Lakṣmaṇa, Bharata and Śatrughna Śeṣa, the Disc and the Conch. ↩
38. *Anubhāṣya*: *kalā-niyamena* — "as part and part of a part"; He abides in the forms of Rāma and others, manifesting them as avatāras for particular purposes (*naimittika*), but He Himself appeared as Kṛṣṇa. ↩
39. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition reads «অধম জীবেরে চড়াইল ঊর্দ্ধ সীমা» ("He raised a fallen soul to the highest limit"), with the heading "The greatness of Nityānanda's mercy shown by the author's own story." Other editions read «যৈছে চড়াইল» ("how He raised…"). ↩
40. *Anubhāṣya*: *avadhūta* — Śrīdhara Svāmī (on *Bhāgavatam*, 3.1.19) explains the word as "one whose body bears no mark of ritual purification": Nityānanda, eternally perfect and beyond varṇāśrama, bore none of its signs and was absorbed in the mood of Vraja. On Mīnaketana Rāmadāsa see Ādi 11.53. ↩

41. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «বসিয়া» (“sitting”; another reading: «আসিয়া», “having come”). *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Guṇārṇava Miśra, the servant of the Deity, did not greet Nityānanda’s servant who was sitting in the courtyard. ↩
42. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya* and *Anubhāṣya* (*Bhāgavatam* 10.78.22–28): in Naimiṣāraṇya Romaharṣaṇa, a disciple of Vyāsa, did not rise to greet Baladeva and was slain by Him; Guṇārṇava Miśra, who had no special regard for Nityānanda, acted just as improperly. The devotees do not blame Mīnaketana for this anger. ↩
43. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: “the logic of half a hen” is to take one half of a hen as old and the other as young; so too, by accepting one of the undivided Caitanya and Nityānanda and rejecting the other, you show both unbelief and hypocrisy. ↩
44. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Jhāmaṭapura is a village near Naihāṭi, two krośas north of Kāṭoyā; Kavirāja Gosvāmī lived there, and a Deity of Mahāprabhu is now worshipped there. ↩
45. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «দন্তে» (“in the teeth”; another reading: «দন্ত»). ↩
46. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *hātasāna* — “a touch of the hand”. ↩
47. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *bhakti-rasa-prānta* — “only nearness to bhakti-rasa”. *Anubhāṣya*: Śrī Sanātana is the ācārya of the conclusions of bhakti, Śrī Rūpa the ācārya of bhakti-rasa (cf. Antya 4). ↩
48. *Anubhāṣya*: Brahmā, seated on the lotus, together with the inhabitants of Brahmaloka meditates on Govinda, the Deity worshipped with the eighteen-syllable mantra, on whom the dwellers of all fourteen worlds meditate. ↩
49. *Anubhāṣya*: in the guise of a prohibition the verse says that this form, the abode of supreme beauty, must certainly be seen: once its sweetness is tasted, all else seems worthless. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: having seen Śrī Govinda, one loses the taste for everything else. ↩
50. The edition’s heading: “To see the transcendental Deity as earthly stone, wood or metal is a great offence.” *Anubhāṣya* cites the *Bhakti-sandarbha* (286): true worshippers see the Deity as the Supreme Lord Himself, for the idea of a difference destroys bhakti; and the *Padma-purāṇa*: one who sees stone in the Deity of Viṣṇu is called bound for hell. ↩
51. *Anubhāṣya*: Nitāi’s merciful command (5.195) is the main sūtra by which the *Caritāmṛta* was written in Vṛndāvana, the land of the Vaiṣṇavas. ↩